TEXORA · SESSIONAL NOTES · STUDY SHEET

Pattern Pieces of a Basic Shirt: Front, Back, Sleeve, Collar, Yoke and Cuff

Examining the production set piece by piece — the shape features of each component, its grain line, its allowances and its cut quantity — so that every piece can be recognised, checked and explained on its own.

TE-2208 · APPAREL MANUFACTURING TECHNOLOGY-1 SESSIONAL · STUDY 4 · LEVEL 2 TERM 2

1. Aim and place of the study

Aim: to draw and explain each pattern piece of the basic shirt separately — front, back, sleeve, collar, yoke and cuff (with the pocket) — identifying its shape features, grain line and allowances. Study 3 produced the set; this study is the piece-by-piece examination an examiner conducts when the set is laid out on the table: pick up any piece, and its owner must be able to defend it.

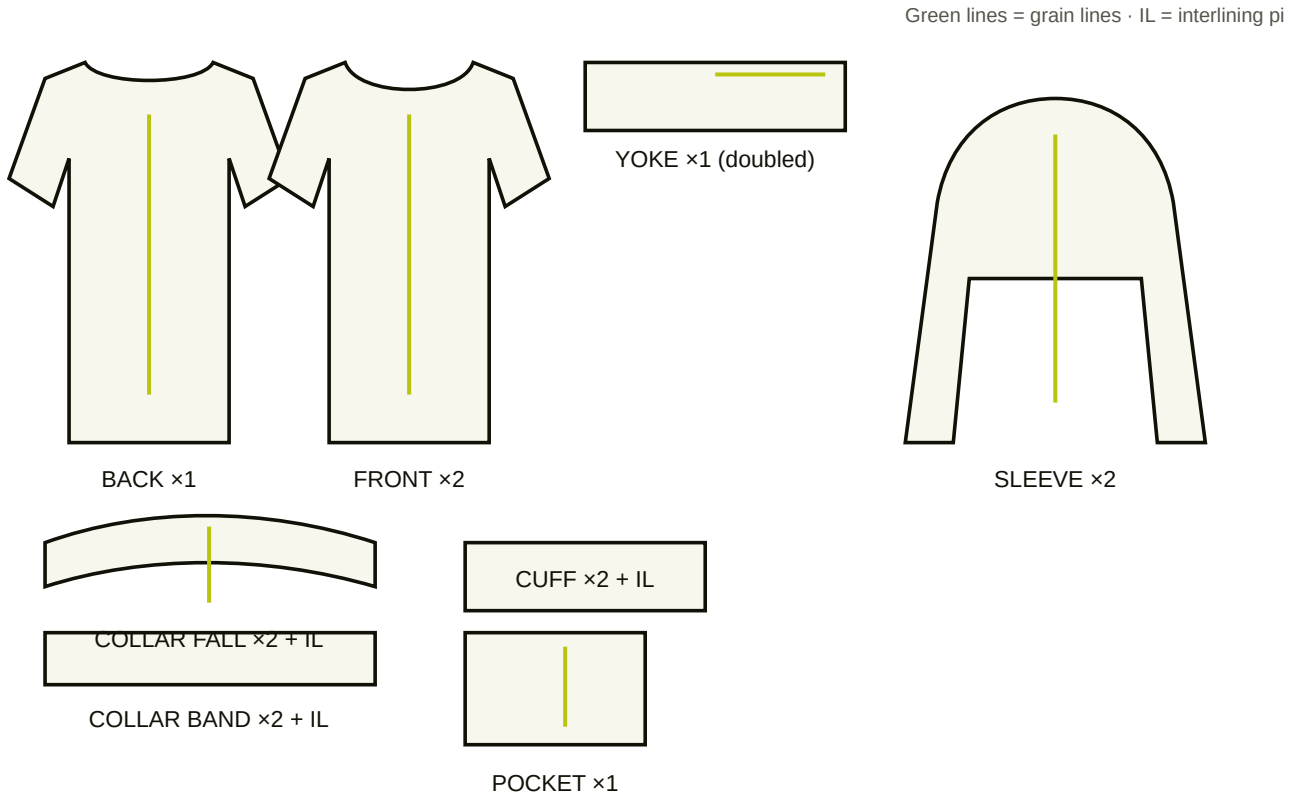


Figure 1 — The complete production pattern set of the basic shirt, laid out piece by piece (schematic, not to scale). Every piece carries its grain line; the small pieces carry interlining pieces of the same shape.

2. The pieces, one by one

2.1 Back (cut 1)

Shape features: the widest body piece, symmetric about the centre-back line, with a shallow neckline curve at the top (about 2 cm deep), the yoke seam line across the upper part where the separate yoke joins, and pleat marks below that line. Its lower portion is longer in appearance than the front's because the front loses length to its deeper neck shaping — both share the same hem level and side-seam length. **Grain:** along the centre-back line. **Allowances:** 1.5 cm at the centre-back/yoke region where adjustment is provided for in this course's standard, 1 cm shoulder and armhole, 2.5 cm hem. **Marks:** double notches (back convention), pleat positions, yoke joining notches.

2.2 Front (cut 2 — a pair)

Shape features: two mirrored pieces; deep front neckline curve (about 7–8 cm below the shoulder line), the grown-on button placket extension of about 2 cm beyond the centre-front line on both pieces (button side and buttonhole side), pocket drill marks on the left front. **Grain:** parallel to the centre-front line. **Allowances:** 1 cm on armhole, shoulder and placket fold; 1.5 cm side seam; 2.5 cm hem. **Marks:** single notches (front convention), button positions along the placket, pocket drills.

2.3 Yoke (cut 1, usually doubled)

Shape features: a shallow horizontal panel whose top edge is the shoulder/neck shape of the back and whose bottom edge is the straight or gently curved yoke line; its ends carry the top of the armhole. When doubled, the two layers enclose the shoulder seams of front and back (the cleanest shirt construction). **Grain:** across the panel, parallel to its bottom edge in most shirt styles — the grain direction must be stated on the piece, as styles differ. **Allowances:** 1 cm all round, 1.5 cm at the centre back when an adjustment seam is used. **Marks:** centre-back notch, armhole notches matching front and back.

2.4 Sleeve (cut 2 — a pair)

Shape features: the cap curve at the top — the most demanding curve of the set — whose length equals the armhole plus about 1–1.5 cm of cap ease; front and back halves of the cap differ (the front cap is slightly more hollowed), identified by the single/double notch convention. The underarm seams run to the cuff opening; the back underarm carries the sleeve placket position. **Grain:** along the sleeve centre line, from cap top to cuff. **Allowances:** 1 cm on cap and underarm seams; the cuff end takes the allowance required by the cuff construction. **Marks:** cap-top notch (matches the shoulder point), front/back notches, placket drill.

2.5 Collar — fall and band (each cut 2 layers + interlining)

Shape features: the **fall** is the visible outer collar: a shaped piece, wider at the centre back (about 4.5–5 cm in the Study 3 draft), tapering to the styled points at the front. The **band (stand)** is a gently curved strip about 3 cm wide whose lower edge is sewn to the neckline and whose curve must match the neckline length of 40 cm exactly. Both pieces are cut in pairs of layers (top and under) with an interlining piece of the same shape. **Grain:** fall and band on the straight grain along their length, so the collar neither twists nor stretches around the neck. **Allowances:** only 0.6–0.75 cm — these are enclosed, curved seams where extra fabric becomes bulk that no pressing can remove.

2.6 Cuff (cut 2 + interlining)

Shape features: a rectangle (about 26.5 cm long including overlap, 6–7 cm wide in the Study 3 draft) with square or rounded outer corners by style; one end carries the button, the other the buttonhole, positioned by drill marks. **Grain:** along its length. **Allowances:** 0.6–0.75 cm on the enclosed edges, as for the collar. The sleeve placket piece (a narrow strip) belongs to the cuff group and is cut with it.

2.7 Pocket (cut 1)

Shape features: a small rectangle with a shaped bottom (pointed or rounded by style), a top hem allowance of about 2.5–3 cm folded inside to form the pocket facing, and 1 cm turning allowances on the other edges. Its position on the front is fixed by the drill marks of Study 3, never by eye at the sewing table.

3. The set as a whole — the completeness check

PIECE	CUT QUANTITY	GRAIN DIRECTION	IDENTITY MARKS
Back	×1	Centre-back line	Double notches; pleat marks
Front	×2 (pair)	Centre-front line	Single notches; button & pocket drills
Yoke	×1 (doubled)	Across the panel	Centre-back notch; armhole notches
Sleeve	×2 (pair)	Sleeve centre line	Cap-top notch; single/double cap notches; placket drill
Collar fall	×2 layers + interlining	Along its length	Centre-back notch; point shape by style
Collar band	×2 layers + interlining	Along its length	Centre-back notch; ends marked L/R by button positions
Cuff	×2 + interlining	Along its length	Button and buttonhole drills

Pocket	×1	Vertical, as worn	Top hem line marked

A set that passes this table — quantities, grains, marks — is a complete set. The examination habit this study teaches: lay the pieces out as in Figure 1, count them against the component list of Study 2, and read each information block aloud. Missing pieces are found on the table, or they are found later at far greater cost.

4. Precautions

- Never separate a pair to "check one": pairs are checked together, mirrored against each other.
- Interlining pieces are cut from the same pattern shape (net of the outer edge allowances where the construction requires) and stored with their shell pieces, not in a common pile.
- Small pieces (collar, cuff, pocket) are the most often lost and the most often cut off-grain in a hurry — their grain lines are checked first in this study.
- Store the set flat or hung by its largest pieces, pieces clipped together by garment, away from the dust of the cutting section (Study 1).

5. Practice (viva preparation)

Answer in your own words; brief model answers follow.

1. State the cut quantity of every piece of the shirt set, including interlining pieces.
2. Why does the collar band's length admit no tolerance, while the sleeve cap is deliberately longer than the armhole?
3. Identify a piece from its description alone: "a shallow panel, doubled, enclosing the shoulder seams, grain across its width." State its function.
4. Why do collar and cuff pieces carry only 0.6–0.75 cm allowance when the side seam carries 1.5 cm?
5. The front cap of the sleeve is more hollowed than the back. How is each identified on the pattern, and what goes wrong if they are exchanged?
6. A set is laid out and the pocket piece is missing. At which later stages would the absence be discovered if not found now, and what does each discovery cost?
7. Why is the fall's grain line along its length rather than across it?

Answer key

1. Back ×1; front ×2 (pair); yoke ×1 (usually doubled); sleeve ×2 (pair); collar fall ×2 layers + interlining; collar band ×2 layers + interlining; cuff ×2 + interlining; pocket ×1; sleeve placket strips ×2.

2. The band must close exactly around the fixed neckline of 40 cm — longer or shorter cannot be sewn in without distortion. The cap's extra 1–1.5 cm is designed ease, distributed over the armhole to shape the sleeve head roundly over the shoulder.
3. The yoke. It joins front and back across the shoulders and, when doubled, encloses and finishes the shoulder seams between its layers.
4. Collar and cuff seams are enclosed and curved; a wide allowance becomes bulk inside a narrow band and prevents a smooth, sharp edge. The side seam is a long, straight, load-bearing seam where width gives strength and future adjustment.
5. By the notch convention — single notch on the front cap edge, double on the back. Exchanged, the sleeves hang twisted: the cap ease sits in the wrong places and the sleeve's hang and crease line rotate on the arm.
6. At the marker (the set cannot be completed), at cutting (found when pieces are counted), or at sewing when the front reaches pocket attachment with no pocket — each stage later multiplies the cost: re-cutting from remnant fabric, shade-matching risk, and a stopped line.
7. The collar wraps around the neck along its length; lengthwise (warp) grain is the stable direction, so the collar keeps its circumference and edge shape through wear and washing instead of stretching and curling.

Texora — course notes prepared from the official syllabus of B.Sc. in Textile Engineering · Made by Sakib